

Our intelligence gathering network is in a shambles and the rot in the security set-up across the country is too deep. It requires radical remedies and not just knee-jerk treatment. The police, the security and the intelligence agencies will have to reorient themselves to cope with the new phase in terrorism.

DR. VITULL K. GUPTA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Success Buzz

Spellbinding stories of unusual entrepreneurs have once again proved that an enterprising spirit will sooner or later achieve astounding success, irrespective of one's educational or financial background ("The Lotus in the Swamp", December 8). All it takes is a resolute mind and a never-say-die attitude.

VIRENDRA TANGRI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Troubled Waters

The sharing of water resources in South Asia has got murky political overtones ("Rivers of Conflict", November 24). Despite international arbitration, Pakistan has been raising objections over the Baglihar Project, thinking that India could be browbeaten into stalling work on it just as it did in the case of the Kishanganga and the Tulbul projects. India's other neighbours, including China, Bangladesh and Nepal, aren't amenable to mutually beneficial

joint projects that could resolve the disputes.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
via www.indiatoday.in

In the Firing Line

The story ("The Job Squeeze", November 24) features the elaborate comment of one of the former employees of Dexterity, Nagaraj Kumaresan, expressing his personal feelings. Some facts about the company were misrepresented in the article. The story claims that Dexterity has started losing key clients and this has prompted the company to lay off around 14 per cent of its employees.

confusion amongst our stakeholders and could affect our prospects with potential clients.

JAYARAM EASWARAN,
Chief (Business Development),
Dexterity

The article was based on what Nagaraj Kumaresan, a former Dexterity employee, told our reporter. The article was aimed at presenting the impact of the global meltdown on the Indian economy and the job market. There was no intention of causing angst or confusion among your stakeholders and potential clients.

EDITOR



BANDEEP SINGH

Devoting a whole issue to analyse the kinky tendencies of just 6,000 Indians with the virtual exclusion of everything else that could interest the remaining one billion was a bit too much.

M.H. RAO, Hyderabad

This information is incorrect and baseless. We have not lost any key clients and consequently have had no reason to lay off any employee. This article has caused unnecessary angst and

Clarification

From the Editor-in-Chief ("Pledge to Win This War", December 15) said that terrorist violence has claimed 2,000 lives in India since 1998. That figure should read 20,000.

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30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JANUARY 16-31, 1979

Born to Work

Twelve-year-old Anil Das works in a dingy little working class *dhaba* in Bhowanipur, South Calcutta. On New Year's Day, a large group of labourers, working on Calcutta's U-rail, pitched up their tents nearby and since then, the *dhaba* has been working overtime. Starting as early as 4 o'clock, Anil works unceasingly for 17 hours. Sometimes while he works, his thoughts go back to his village in Midnapore where his mother is suffering from consumption, while his brothers and sisters desperately fight against starvation. His face brightens as he remembers the two pieces of good news 1979 has brought him—that his mother's health is improving and that he has been promised Rs 40 instead of Rs 25 for his 17-hour grind. As he vigorously stirs the tea, he dreams of the day when he can set up his own little *dhaba* and earn more money to help his family.

